

Emelia Cordell

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Summary

Aviation operations professional and FAA Commercial Pilot currently delivering white-glove service to private aviation clients at Signature Aviation's Van Nuys FBO. Track record of building departments and automating workflows across a high-tempo flight school environment: co-founded United Flight Systems' Student Success department from zero, drove social media to doubled engagement, and won the Textron Aviation Top Hawk competition — securing a brand-new aircraft for the school. Held five concurrent roles as Executive Assistant, dispatcher, bookkeeper, front-line student coach, and social media director, while founding a community organization now serving 250 families annually. Based in Los Angeles and bringing deep operational instincts alongside genuine aviation passion to every role.

Core Competencies

Aviation Operations • Flight Dispatch & Scheduling • Student Success & Retention • Executive Support • Process Automation • Social Media Strategy • Video Production • Financial Operations • Team Leadership • FAA Compliance • Vendor Management • 24/7 Client Support • Community Development • Volunteer Coordination

Experience

Signature Aviation, Van Nuys, CA

Guest Experience Specialist, June 2026–Present

- Deliver white-glove service to private and business aviation passengers, flight crews, and VIP clients at the Van Nuys FBO, one of the busiest general aviation airports in the world.
- Manage the full arrival and departure experience: passenger greeting, lounge hospitality, ground transportation coordination, and catering requests.
- Coordinate with line service, dispatch, and flight crews to ensure seamless, discreet, and on-time handling.
- Maintain a premium terminal environment and anticipate client needs in a high-tempo, high-profile aviation setting.

United Flight Systems, Spring, TX

Executive Assistant to CEO, Student Success Co-Founder, and Operations Assistant, November 2023–June 2026

- Served on the company's Leadership Team as the CEO's primary support — overseeing executive communications, travel coordination, media relations, and high-level vendor management.
- Co-founded the Student Success department: built a white-glove training management system tailored to each student's schedule, goals, financial situation, and timeline — delivering 24/7 support throughout their training journey.
- Directed all social media strategy, content production, and video — doubled engagement across all platforms and drove measurable enrollment growth.
- Managed full-cycle financial operations: invoicing, reconciliations, monthly reporting, and student financial planning.
- Served as the CEO's designated representative in their absence — managing internal operations, external partnerships, and client-facing communications.
- Systematically automated core responsibilities to continuously expand scope — absorbing dispatch, bookkeeping, HR support, and event production without adding headcount.
- Administered the company Scholarship Program end-to-end: applications, outreach, selection coordination, and award logistics.
- Planned and produced company events and community engagements that built school culture and elevated local aviation market visibility.
- Served as DHS Registered Provider Agent, managing international student enrollment, visa compliance, and SEVIS reporting under the Student and Exchange Visitor Program (SEVP).
- Oversaw office management, vendor relationships, supply inventory, and daily operational readiness for a busy Part 61/141 flight school.

Hair Rescue, Klein, TX

Office Manager & Customer Support, May 2022–September 2024

- Managed client scheduling, onboarding, and follow-up using Square and Google Workspace.
- Implemented customer service improvements that increased repeat bookings by 25%.
- Coordinated payroll, vendor communication, and inventory management.
- Trained new staff on booking procedures, client communication standards, and daily administrative workflows.

Community Leadership

Feeding Houston, Houston, TX

Founder, August 2017–Present

- Founded and lead a community organization that has served 250+ families annually for 8+ years through a network of 50+ sponsors and community partners.
- Built all fundraising, logistics, and volunteer coordination systems from scratch (ClickUp).
- Supervise a team of 20 volunteers across onboarding, training, and program delivery.
- Manage 50+ sponsor relationships to sustain consistent funding and community impact.

Projects

Textron Aviation Top Hawk Competition — National Winner

United Flight Systems, April 2025

- Competed in the nationwide Textron Aviation Top Hawk competition on behalf of United Flight Systems.
- Produced a 15-minute documentary showcasing the school's mission, facilities, and industry partnerships (ForeFlight, King Schools, E&E Aviation), accompanied by a written narrative and an aircraft integration plan.
- Won a brand-new airplane for the school — immediately boosting aircraft utilization and enrollment traction.
- Video: youtube.com/watch?v=6R2RspCSulU · txtav.com/en/top-hawk

Education

University of Houston–Downtown, Houston, TX

Bachelor of Science, May 2024–Present · Robert B. Watts Scholarship recipient (2024–2025)

University of Nebraska–Lincoln, Lincoln, NE

August 2021–June 2022 · George Beadle Scholarship recipient (2021–2023)

Honors

Top Hawk Winner, United Flight Systems, Spring, TX — April 2025

Robert B. Watts Scholarship, United Flight Systems, Spring, TX — May 2024–May 2025

George Beadle Scholarship, University of Nebraska–Lincoln, Lincoln, NE — August 2021–June 2023

Skills

FAA Commercial Pilot Certificate — Single Engine Land | Instrument Rating — Airplane

Computer: QuickBooks, Excel, ClickUp, Microsoft Suite, Google Workspace, Square, Adobe Suite

Language: American Sign Language (conversational)

Certifications

DHS Registered Provider Agent — *Student and Exchange Visitor Program (SEVP), U.S. Department of Homeland Security*

Veterans Affairs School Certifying Official (SCO)

Cardiopulmonary Resuscitation (CPR), June 2023